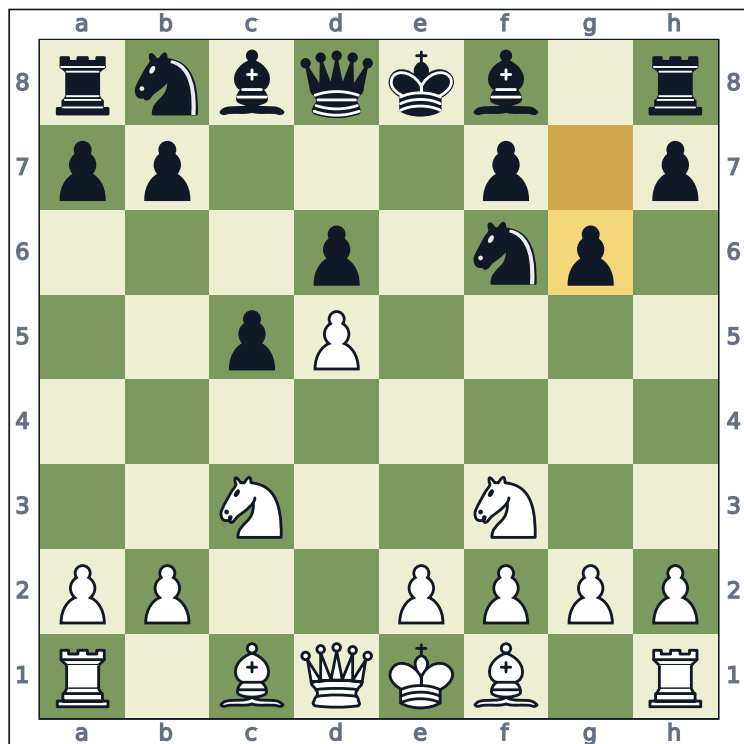


BENONI, BENKO, AND INDIAN STRUCTURES

Benoni Defense

ECO A61 | 4 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Playable, but White has a meaningful objective edge. Black needs accurate counterplay.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.93 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

A61 covers Benoni Defense. The center becomes asymmetric: White often owns space, while Black seeks dynamic files, diagonals, and pawn breaks. The diagram uses the featured line Benoni Defense.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 c5 4. d5 exd5 5. cxd5 d6 6. Nc3 g6

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Use the space advantage, finish development, support e4, and prepare a central or queenside expansion without overextending.

BLACK'S GOALS

Attack the pawn center with ...e6, ...c5, or ...b5, activate the dark-squared bishop, and create counterplay before White consolidates.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

White commonly uses e5 or b4; Black's thematic resources include ...e6, ...b5, and sometimes ...f5.

PIECE MAP

White's central pawns need piece support. Black's bishops and rooks become strong when files open on the queenside. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Space is valuable but can become a target. A premature pawn advance may leave weak squares behind it. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

White moves next. Material is level. Central markers: Black pawn on c5, White pawn on d5, Black pawn on d6.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

Good for ambitious players: strategically rich and fully playable, but many lines require comfort with imbalance.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named A61 line

This section preserves all 4 names and defining routes assigned to A61 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Benoni Defense

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 c5 4. d5 exd5 5. cxd5 d6 6. Nc3 g6

002 Benoni Defense: Fianchetto Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 c5 4. d5 exd5 5. cxd5 d6 6. Nc3 g6 7. g3

003 Benoni Defense: Knight's Tour Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 c5 4. d5 exd5 5. cxd5 d6 6. Nc3 g6 7. Nd2

004 Benoni Defense: Uhlmann Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 c5 4. d5 exd5 5. cxd5 d6 6. Nc3 g6 7. Bg5